Try Hack Me   Dashboard   Learn   Practice   Compete   0   0

Cyber Security 101 > Start Your Cyber Security Journey > Offensive Security Intro

Offensive Security Intro

Introducing offensive security, where you will test the security of FakeBank's systems.

20 min   1,533,436

Save Room   Options

Room progress: 0%

Task 1 Think like a Hacker!

Offensive Security is about thinking like an attacker to find weaknesses before real hackers do. The opposite, defensive security, is about keeping hackers out and acting when it goes wrong.

Two people work at the same bank. Read what each is doing:

Sarah TESTING LOGINS

Tries logging into the bank's website using common passwords on a test account, to see whether it accepts weak ones.

Mike ADDING A FIREWALL RULE

Adds a firewall rule that prevents suspicious login attempts on their systems.

Answer the questions below

Which person is doing offensive security?

- (•) Sarah
- ( ) Mike

✓ Correct Answer

Task 2 Starting the Lab

This room uses a virtual desktop to simulate a real system. Press the green "View Site" button below to get started.

View Site

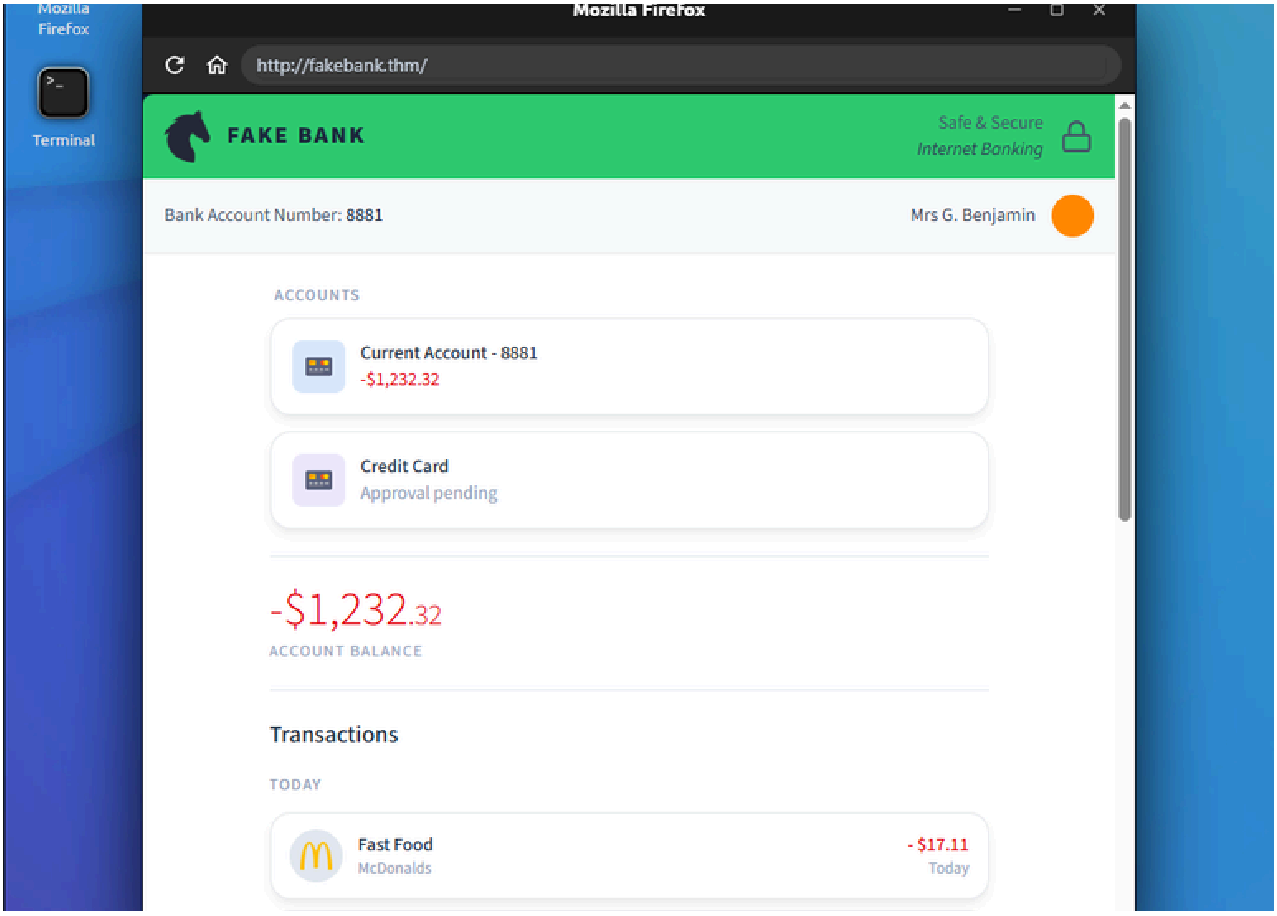
A fake banking application called FakeBank will launch. When the lab loads, you'll see the banking application running in your browser on the right, showing Mrs G. Benjamin's banking account.

Answer the questions below

What is the bank account number shown in the FakeBank application?

8881

✓ Correct Answer



Task 3 Find Hidden Pages

Now we will find a weakness in the FakeBank website. One common thing Hackers look for on a website is pages that are not linked. Hackers are interested in these hidden pages because they can often lead to sensitive pages or information that the organisation did not intend for us to see.

We can use popular cyber security tooling to find these pages by using common words and phrases, such as "login", "admin", etc. One of those tools is `dirb`, which can be used in the terminal.

The terminal is used to interact with the device and cyber security tools.

View Site

Inside the terminal, `dirb` is used by providing the command and the URL to test. For example:

```
dirb http://example.com
```

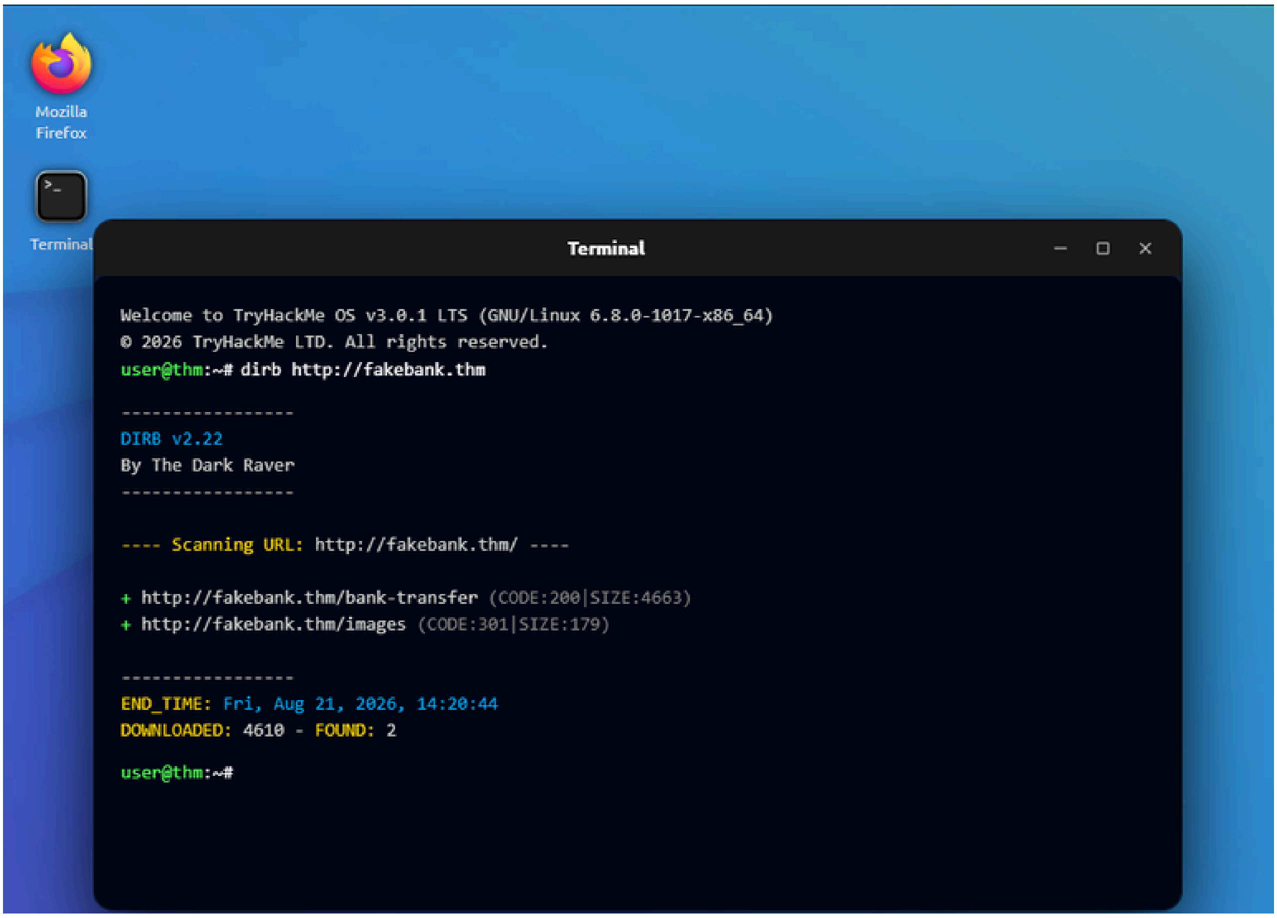
Use this knowledge to scan `http://fakebank.thm` to answer the question below.

Answer the questions below

Dirb found two URLs, which one of these is more likely to give us access to FakeBank's internal tools?

http://fakebank.thm/bank-transfer

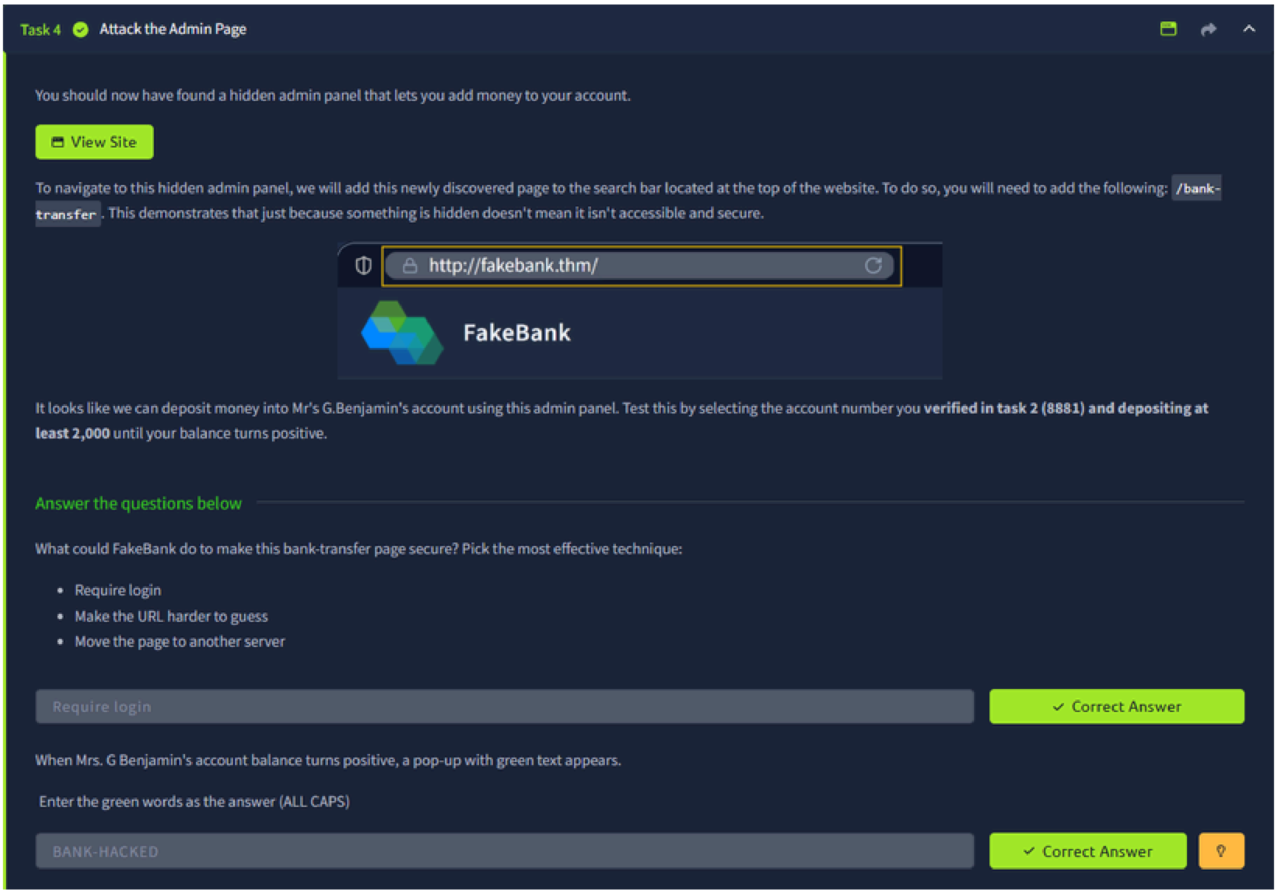
✓ Correct Answer

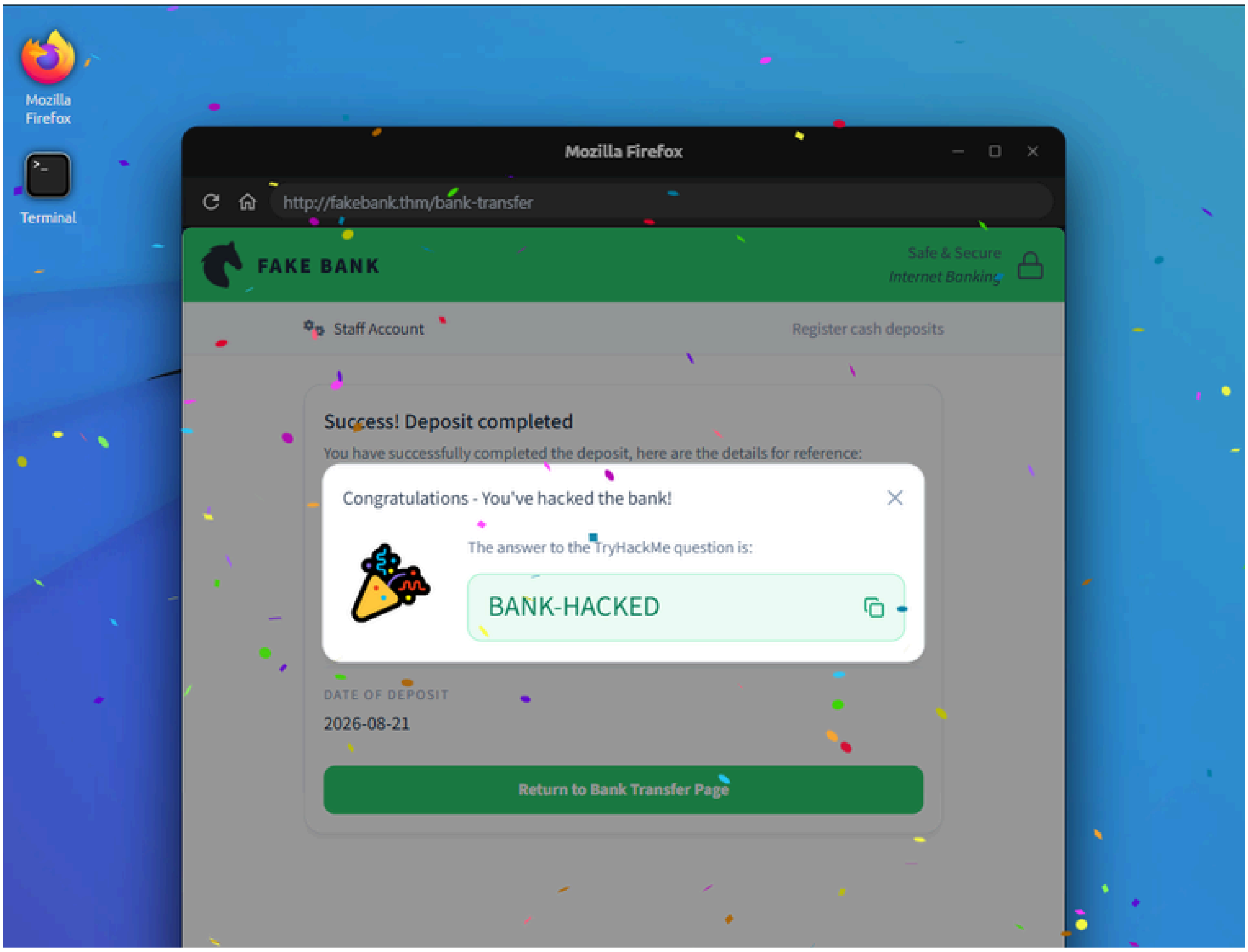

Mozilla Firefox
Terminal
Terminal
Welcome to TryHackMe OS v3.0.1 LTS (GNU/Linux 6.8.0-1017-x86_64)
© 2026 TryHackMe LTD. All rights reserved.
user@thm:~# dirb http://fakebank.thm

DIRB v2.22
By The Dark Raver

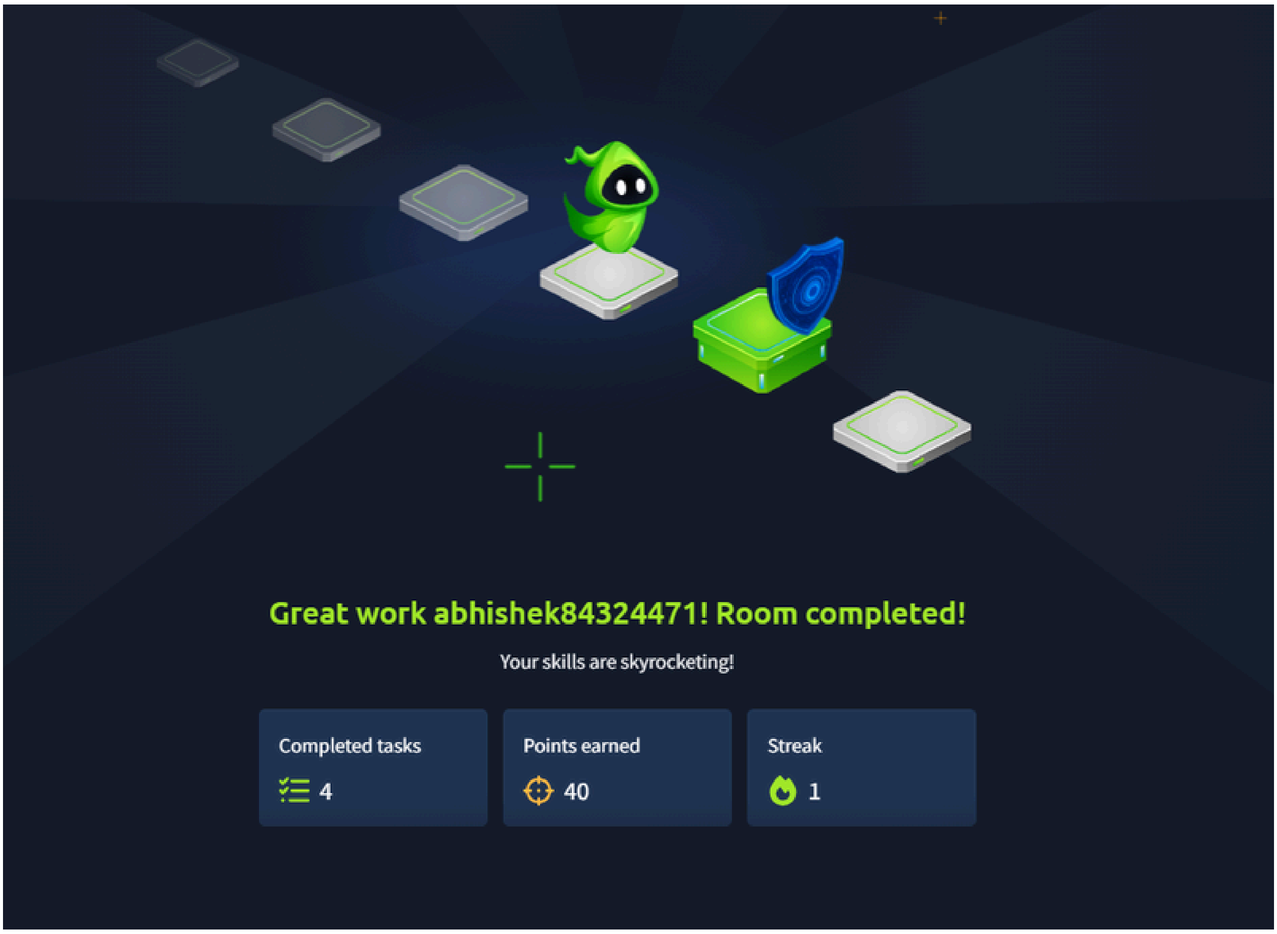
---- Scanning URL: http://fakebank.thm/ ----
+ http://fakebank.thm/bank-transfer (CODE:200|SIZE:4663)
+ http://fakebank.thm/images (CODE:301|SIZE:179)

END_TIME: Fri, Aug 21, 2026, 14:20:44
DOWNLOADED: 4610 - FOUND: 2
user@thm:~#


Task 4 Attack the Admin Page
You should now have found a hidden admin panel that lets you add money to your account.
View Site
To navigate to this hidden admin panel, we will add this newly discovered page to the search bar located at the top of the website. To do so, you will need to add the following: /bank-transfer. This demonstrates that just because something is hidden doesn't mean it isn't accessible and secure.
http://fakebank.thm/
FakeBank
It looks like we can deposit money into Mr's G.Benjamin's account using this admin panel. Test this by selecting the account number you verified in task 2 (8881) and depositing at least 2,000 until your balance turns positive.
Answer the questions below
What could FakeBank do to make this bank-transfer page secure? Pick the most effective technique:
• Require login
• Make the URL harder to guess
• Move the page to another server
Require login
Correct Answer
When Mrs. G Benjamin's account balance turns positive, a pop-up with green text appears.
Enter the green words as the answer (ALL CAPS)
BANK-HACKED
Correct Answer



Mozilla Firefox
Terminal
Mozilla Firefox
http://fakebank.thm/bank-transfer
FAKE BANK
Safe & Secure
Internet Banking
Staff Account
Register cash deposits
Success! Deposit completed
You have successfully completed the deposit, here are the details for reference:
Congratulations - You've hacked the bank!
The answer to the TryHackMe question is:
BANK-HACKED
DATE OF DEPOSIT
2026-08-21
Return to Bank Transfer Page



Great work abhishek84324471! Room completed!
Your skills are skyrocketing!
Completed tasks
4
Points earned
40
Streak
1

Try Hack Me   Dashboard   Learn   Practice   Compete

Pre Security > Introduction to Cyber Security > Defensive Security Intro

Defensive Security Intro

Introducing defensive security, where you will protect FakeBank from an ongoing attack.

15 min   2,191,353

Save Room   1534 Recommend   Options

Room progress: 25%

Task 1   Think like a Defender

Think like a Defender

Defensive security is the process of defending and securing devices and systems.

Before you can defend a system, you need to understand what defenders are responsible for. Defensive security focuses on detecting and investigating attacks, and responding before damage occurs.

Unlike offensive security, you do not attack systems, instead, you monitor and protect them.

Answer the questions below

What is the main goal of defensive security?

- Detect and respond to attacks
- Attack systems to find flaws

Detect and respond to attacks   ✓ Correct Answer

Task 2   Detect Suspicious Activity

Detect Suspicious Activity

Joe is an apprentice SOC analyst on his first solo shift. A moment ago, his monitoring dashboard lit up - something doesn't look right. Real SOC analysts rely on tools like this every day to separate normal activity from suspicious behaviour, and right now Joe needs your help to investigate before it becomes a serious incident.

This room uses a lab machine to simulate a real system.

You'll need to...

1. Open the monitoring dashboard
2. Review recent alerts
3. Identify the suspicious source IP.

▶ *Why you're doing this*

Answer the questions below

Which source IP address is generating the suspicious traffic?

32.122.195.63

✓ Correct Answer

UNASSIGNED MEDIUM

Web Discovery Attack

Automated directory enumeration detected on admin endpoints

Source IP
32.122.195.63

First Detected
2 minutes ago

Event ID
SEC-000001

Attack Summary

Attack Started
14/07/2025, 10:21:39

Duration
16 minutes 32 seconds

URLs Attempted
31

Blocked Requests
10

URL Discovery Attempts

GET 404 10:39:07 https://fakebank.com/admin Copy URL

Task 3 Identify the Attack

Identify the Attack

Joe has spotted the suspicious activity, but knowing something is wrong is only half the battle. He now needs to figure out what the attacker is actually trying to do. The monitoring dashboard has been tracking every move, and the answers are in there.

Help Joe dig into the data and work out what kind of attack is underway before the attacker finds what they're looking for.

You'll need to...

1. Investigate the attack that has occured.
2. View the "URL Discovery Attempts" list.
3. Look at the latest "URL Discovery Attempts" entry to answer the question.

▼ *Why you're doing this*

The monitoring dashboard shows a history of what the attacker is trying to find on our website. You will see that the dashboard has captured the attacker trying many attempts to access hidden pages, very quickly.

Once we know what the attacker is trying to achieve, we can then begin to take measures to stop the attacker and then finally fix the problem that allowed this attack in the first place.

Answer the questions below

Copy the latest URL that the attacker has tried to find and paste it below.

https://fakebank.com/admin

Correct Answer

Task 4 Stop the Attack

Stop the Attack

Joe knows who the attacker is and what they're trying to do. Now it's time to act. In defensive security, the immediate priority is **containment** (stopping the attack while it's happening) to protect the organisation.

For this stage of the practical, Joe has already completed some security updates, but needs your help to complete the last.

View Site

You'll need to...

1. Review the security actions. Joe has done two of these for you.
2. Block the attacker's IP address below by adding it into the "Add Firewall Rule" textbox on the practical.

```
32.122.195.63
```

3. Make sure to select "**BLOCK**" from the dropdown and press "Apply".

▶ *Why you're doing this*

Answer the questions below

When the success message appears, copy the flag and paste it below.

THM{FAKEBANK-SECURED}

✓ Correct Answer

Try Hack Me Dashboard Learn Practice Compete 0 1

Pre Security > Introduction to Cyber Security > Careers in Cyber

Careers in Cyber

Discover the perks and your place within Cyber Security.

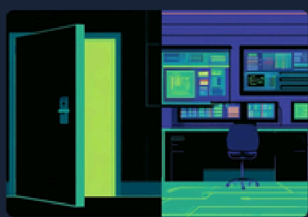
10 min 1,790,505

Save Room 79 Recommend Options

Room progress: 16%

Task 1 The Open Door

The jobs are already there. Are you?



There are millions of cyber security jobs sitting empty right now. Companies, hospitals, banks, and governments have created the roles but can't find the people to fill them.

Cyber security is open to anyone. From former police officers, healthcare workers, finance professionals to teachers and farmers, and much more. Cyber security needs people who understand how the world works, with unique skills, not just knowing how computers work.

Your background isn't a barrier to entry - it might be exactly what the industry is missing.

Answer the questions below

Which of these is true?

- ○ There are enough professionals to fill most roles
- ○ You need a computer science degree to get into cyber
- ◉ Millions of roles are unfilled, and people from all backgrounds can fill them

✓ Correct Answer

Task 2 What It Pays

Well paid. And faster to get there than you think.

Cyber security is one of the best paid fields in technology, and it doesn't require a decade of education to get there.

Entry-level roles pay competitively and Senior roles pay well. The right certifications and practice can take someone from no experience to a well-paying role in a significantly less time it takes to qualify in law, medicine, or finance.

No mandatory degree. No licence that takes years to earn. The barrier to enter cyber security is lower than most people assume, and the pay is good.

Answer the questions below

Which of these is true?

- ( ) You need a four-year degree to be paid well in cyber
- (•) Certifications alone can get you to a well-paying role, faster than most people expect
- ( ) Salaries are similar to general IT support

✓ Correct Answer

Task 3 The Bigger Picture

Protecting the things that can't afford to fail.

When hackers strike and cyber defences fail, the consequences can be critical. Hospitals cancel appointments. Banks freeze. Power grids go down, factories stop production, and personal information that's stolen has impact for years.

These things happen and are happening more often than ever before.

The people who stopped those attacks weren't just lucky. They knew what to look for, and they'd prepared for it. A team of experts, with the right knowledge, at the right moment, prevent serious incidents.

Answer the questions below

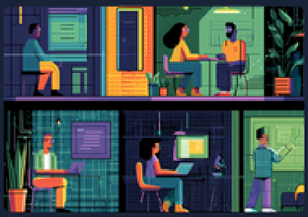
Which of these is true?

- (•) Cyber professionals protect hospitals, power grids, factories, and much more
- ( ) Attacks only hurt the profits of an organisation
- ( ) Cyber attacks only target tech companies

✓ Correct Answer

Task 4 Find Your Place

There's a role for you in Cyber security



Cyber security isn't just one thing. It spans more than 50 recognised roles, from penetration testers and SOC analysts to threat intelligence researchers, incident responders, security engineers and beyond.

Some people in cyber think like attackers, testing systems for weaknesses before the wrong people find them. Others work like detectives, piecing together what happened after an incident. Some thrive on the "cat and mouse" of staying one step ahead of threats in real time. Others prefer the bigger picture, researching how threats evolve before anything goes wrong.

The skills that make people exceptional in these roles aren't just technical. The best problem solvers, the most calm people under pressure, the most curious, they often come from different careers entirely.

What matters is finding your place in this field that fits the way your mind works.

Answer the questions below

Which of these is true?

- ( ) All cybersecurity roles require the same technical skills
- (•) There are many roles in cyber security, and the right one depends on how your mind works
- ( ) Cyber security is a single career path, not a range of different roles

✓ Correct Answer

Task 5 Your Starting Point

Every new technology needs someone to protect it.

Cyber security is one of the fastest growing career fields in the world and that growth shows no sign of slowing. AI, cloud computing, connected healthcare, digital banking, and much more. New technologies create more roles.

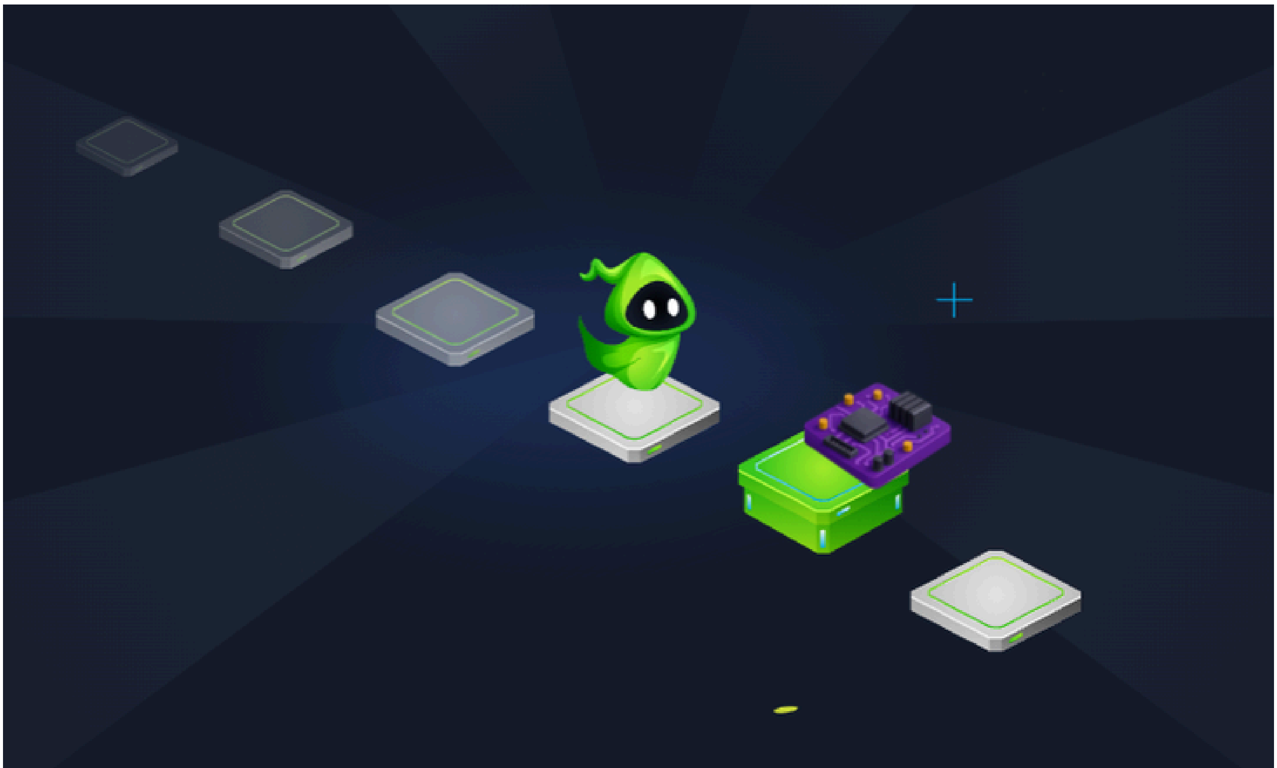
The people filling those roles don't come from one background, one degree, or one path. They start somewhere, usually with a question they couldn't stop asking. Neither do they stay in one place or role, they grow and expand their skills.

Answer the questions below

Which of these is true?

- ( ) The availability of job roles is the same as other job markets
- (•) Cyber security is one of the fastest growing fields, and every new technology expands it further
- ( ) AI will takeover Cyber security, requiring no one

✓ Correct Answer



Great work abhishek84324471! Room completed!

Your skills are skyrocketing!

Completed tasks	Points earned	Streak
6	40	1